

Piotr Usewicz

Senior Software Engineer · Benicàrlo, Spain — Remote (CET, EU/US overlap) · piotr@layer22.com · layer22.com · github.com/pusewicz · linkedin.com/in/piotrusewicz

Software engineer with 20+ years of building web products, most of them in Ruby on Rails. I spent eleven years at Harvest shipping across the whole stack — platform rebuilds, public APIs, integrations, zero-downtime data migrations, developer tooling. Comfortable owning a product from database schema to deploy pipeline; happiest on a small team that ships.

EXPERIENCE

Sabbatical — systems programming, games & open source Oct 2025 – present

A deliberate year off after eleven years at Harvest, spent learning in public.

- Contributed 19 merged pull requests upstream to Cute Framework, a C game framework.
- Built bielik2d, a 2D game engine in pure Swift 6 on SDL3's GPU API, running natively and in the browser (WebAssembly/WebGPU).
- Shipped cf-mcp, an MCP server that gives LLM coding agents searchable Cute Framework documentation (4,500+ downloads).
- Wrote three games in C with SDL3 and Cute Framework while learning the language; made agentic coding workflows part of daily practice.

Senior Software Engineer · Harvest · Remote Dec 2014 – Sep 2025

Time tracking and resource planning SaaS used by 70,000+ companies; fully remote team across nine time zones. Promoted from Software Engineer in July 2021.

- Rebuilt Harvest's embeddable button and widget platform as a React + TypeScript app and shipped it to all customers, coordinating directly with Asana's engineers to keep their desktop integration unbroken.
- Drove the datastore evaluation for the new Events API — built a complete Firestore prototype in under a week and led load tests across MySQL, Firestore, and Elasticsearch; the data reversed the planned choice before it got expensive.
- As Engineering Lead of the Integrations squad, shaped the 2024 roadmap with Product and shipped the Deel payroll integration, designing a timesheet sync that worked around third-party API rate limits.
- Consolidated the Linear, Notion, Monday.com, and Trello browser extensions into one Vite codebase building for Chrome, Edge, and Firefox.
- Self-assigned and completed a multi-year migration to ISO currency codes across the Rails monolith — coordinated database migrations with SRE, zero service disruption.
- Co-built Harvest Developer Tools, cutting new-engineer environment setup to under 30 minutes.
- Modernized the frontend from Backbone/jQuery to React and Preact; shipped Google Calendar and Outlook integrations, MFA, and critical security fixes.
- Mentored six engineers, designed the team's technical interview exercises, reviewed up to 193 PRs per half-year, and helped set Harvest's direction for AI features in 2025.

Senior Software Engineer · Homestay.com · Dublin, Ireland Aug 2012 – Dec 2014

- Designed and implemented core services of the vacation-rental platform (Rails, MySQL) as the product scaled through public launch.

Senior Software Engineer · Mixbook · Palo Alto, California Jan 2012 – Jun 2012

- Shipped customer-facing Rails features on the photo products platform.

Senior Ruby on Rails Developer · HouseTrip · London, UK Sep 2011 – Dec 2011

- Helped build out the development team and engineering processes at a fast-growing holiday-rental startup.

Application Developer · AOL · London, UK

Jun 2011 – Sep 2011

- Built scalable realtime applications in Node.js and Erlang.

Application Developer · Mobile Interactive Group · London, UK

Jan 2008 – Jun 2011

- Kickstarted and led the ground-up rewrite of MIGPay, the group's mobile payments platform (Ruby on Rails + Merb) — new integration tooling for partners and a new mobile web experience for end users.
- Built distributed Erlang systems and SMS payment flows powering digital-goods sales.

Earlier roles · Warsaw, Poland

2004 – 2007

- Head developer at ITSS (PHP content management and e-commerce); led the design and build of an ITIL-based ServiceDesk platform in Ruby on Rails at Exorigo.

OPEN SOURCE

Writing open source since 2008 — gems downloaded ~97,000 times. Everything at github.com/pusewicz.

- **statique** — static site generator in Ruby, built on Roda
- **cf-mcp** — MCP server giving LLM agents searchable Cute Framework docs
- **vimpk** — Vim package manager in Ruby
- **bielik2d** — 2D game engine in Swift 6 on SDL3, native + WebAssembly

SKILLS

Primary	Ruby, Rails, MySQL/SQL, GraphQL, REST API design
Frontend	JavaScript, TypeScript, React, Preact, Hotwire/Stimulus, Tailwind
Also	C, Swift, mruby; production Erlang, Node.js and PHP in past lives
Practices	TDD, code review, zero-downtime migrations, load testing, developer tooling, AI-assisted development
Languages	Polish (native) · English (fluent) · Spanish (intermediate)